

Higher (Rhythm Guitar) -- Creed

Creed, from Human Clay (1999). About 85 BPM, est. Rhythm guitar with two jobs: a clean, open, shimmery tone for the quiet verse parts and a big, thick, driven tone for the chorus. Late-90s post-grunge, built around Mark Tremonti's big-amp crunch. Built from the band's general sound; the exact guitars and amps on the record are not verified, and the light chorus on the clean tone is my assumption.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Neck or middle pickup for the clean tone. Bridge humbucker for the driven tone. GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: Match CL + CAB: V30112 IR (User IR 10)

V30112 (Celestion V30 in an isolation cabinet, sub mic blended in for low end) -- the loaded guitar cab with real weight for the driven chorus, and still fine for the clean tone. Chosen over EVM112 because the driven tone is the one that needs a cab with some bite.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 25.

Covers the driven tone, where the gain and boost stack picks up noise. 25 stops hiss and hum between chords without choking note decay in the clean tone.

PRE -- Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 45, +3dB: on, Bright: off.

On CTL. Pushes the distortion harder for the chorus and adds level. Bright off keeps it thick, not fizzy.

DST -- La Charger, on CTL.

Gain: 55, Tone: 55, VOL: 62.

On CTL. A crunch-box distortion is the main driven sound here, since the clean amp cannot do it on its own.

Gain 55 is thick but keeps chord definition.

AMP -- Match CL, always on.

Gain: 30, PRES: 50, VOL: 62, Bass: 50, Middle: 52, Treble: 50.

Matchless Chieftain clean. A clear, chimy clean base with good headroom for the verse. In driven mode it works as the amp for the pedal stack, so it stays tight and does not add its own mud.

CAB -- User IR 10 (V30112), always on.

VOL: 60.

V30112 IR.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: -2, 500Hz: 0, 1kHz: +1, 3kHz: +1, 6kHz: -1, VOL: 50.

Always on. Low cut keeps the driven chords tight. Slight 1kHz and 3kHz lift for presence in both tones. -1 at 6kHz takes some fizz off the distortion.

MOD -- A-Chorus, always on.

Depth: 15, Rate: 0.5, Tone: 50.

Light hand. Depth 15 and a slow 0.5Hz rate add a bit of width to the clean arpeggios. It stays under the distortion when CTL is on.

DLY -- off. No delay. Chords and arpeggios stay clean and direct.

RVB -- Hall, always on.

Mix: 14, Decay: 35, Trail: off.

Always on. A small hall for space on the clean tone. Mix 14 keeps it out of the way of the driven chords.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: PRE (Boost), DST (La Charger).

- **CTL off** -- Clean rhythm. Match CL clean amp, light chorus, small hall. Open chords and arpeggios. This is the resting state. This is the resting state the patch loads into.

- **CTL on** -- Driven rhythm. La Charger distortion plus a Boost stack up in front of the same clean amp for a thick, saturated chord sound.

Engage CTL for the chorus and any heavy driven section. Back off for the verse and the clean parts.